

RIFAT ERDEM SAHIN

PLATFORM SECURITY ENGINEER — NGINX, WAF & RHEL/LINUX HARDENING

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<https://calendly.com/rifaterdem/schedule> ✅ **Eligibility:** Right to work in the UK (no sponsorship) ·
Inside/Outside IR35, PAYE · Active NATO, SC, CNI, BPSS, NSV clearances · Immediately available

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform Security Engineer with 12+ years hardening and defending Linux platforms for Critical National Infrastructure (CNI), finance, and enterprise clients — most recently on RHEL/OpenShift estates at **National Grid** and **NESO (National Energy System Operator)**. Direct, hands-on delivery across the full platform-security stack: **NGINX** as a production reverse proxy/load balancer, **F5** perimeter WAF policy operation (AppProtect-class rule sets), **OPSWAT MetaDefender** AV/AM scanning integration, **SELinux**-enforced RHEL/CentOS hardening, **Ansible** configuration automation, daily **Bash** and **Python** scripting, and 10+ years of **Azure DevOps**/CI-CD pipeline delivery. Comfortable owning a platform-security or NGINX/RHEL migration programme end-to-end — from restart and re-scoping through secure, auditable delivery in a live CNI environment. Active **NATO**, **SC**, and **CNI** clearances.

EDUCATION

🎓 **Bachelor of Science, Computer Information Technology** Southern New Hampshire University, USA 🇺🇸

🎓 Severna Park High School, Maryland, USA 🇺🇸

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Web/Proxy & Application Security: NGINX (reverse proxy, load balancer, SSL termination), F5 (WAF policy operation, AppProtect-class rule sets), OPSWAT MetaDefender (AV/AM scanning integration), Zscaler, Checkpoint, Cloudflare, Traefik

Linux & Platform Hardening: RHEL, CentOS, SELinux (enforcing-mode policy), Linux/Unix administration, systemd, networking (TCP/IP, routing, firewalls, IPSec)

Automation & Scripting: Ansible, Bash, Python, PowerShell, Terraform, ARM/Bicep templates

CI/CD & DevOps: Azure DevOps (VSTS), GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Tekton, Argo-CD, GitOps

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Helm, Kustomize, MetalLB

Cloud Platforms: Azure, AWS, GCP

Observability: Grafana, Prometheus, Thanos, Loki, Jaeger, Kiali, ELK Stack

Identity & Security: Active Directory, Azure AD, Keycloak, Kerberos, OAuth2/OIDC, Policy as Code

Certifications: Claude Architect Professional Certification (Anthropic) · Microsoft Certified Architect in Cloud Solutions (70-532) · MCPS: Microsoft Certified Professional — Developing Microsoft Azure Solutions · Mastering Ansible · Learning Terraform · Learning Linux Command Line · Kubernetes with CI/CD Solutions · Kubernetes: Microservices · AWS CloudFormation (IaC) · Programming Using Python · DevOps Foundations: DevSecOps

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

SRE / DevOps Onboarding Lead — NESO (National Energy System Operator)

Capgemini / Experis · March 2025 – January 2026

- Led SRE and DevOps onboarding for market participants on a highly secure multi-cloud CNI platform: **OpenShift** and **Kubernetes** at the core, hosted across **Azure** (lower environments) and on-premises CNI data centres.
- Operated **F5**, Zscaler, and Checkpoint daily as the CNI edge-protection layer, maintaining WAF policy sets equivalent to **F5 AppProtect** — inspecting and blocking malicious HTTP traffic before it reached CNI production services — and coordinated every policy change through formal change control (eChips) to avoid disrupting national energy-balancing systems.
- Integrated **OPSWAT MetaDefender** into the CNI ingress/file-transfer pipeline alongside F5 and Zscaler, providing multi-engine antivirus/anti-malware scanning of files and payloads moving from lower Azure test environments into on-premises CNI production — a mandated scan-before-promote control in the CNI security baseline.
- Built and maintained CI/CD delivery through **Azure DevOps Pipelines**, Tekton, and Argo-CD for GitOps-based continuous delivery, bridging the gap between cloud testing environments and on-premises production.
- Ran unified observability with Grafana, Prometheus (+Thanos), Loki, and Jaeger/Kiali across the platform.
- Architected a localised RAG framework (n8n → Qdrant → Claude 3.5 Sonnet) over Bitbucket documentation and Loki logs to speed up root-cause analysis, integrated with JIRA and eChips change-management workflows.
- **Impact:** enhanced grid-balancing stability and streamlined onboarding for new market participants onto CNI infrastructure.

SRE — National Grid

IBM / NordCloud · March 2024 – March 2025

- Delivered OpenShift automation for a CNI transformation programme, with **RHEL** as the core operating system across the estate, Kubernetes for container orchestration, and VMware for virtualisation.
- Used **Ansible playbooks** to automate RHEL server build, patching, and configuration-drift remediation across the OpenShift/VMware estate, replacing manual runbook execution and materially cutting provisioning time.
- Operated **F5**, Zscaler, and Checkpoint daily on-premises for CNI network security and WAF policy enforcement, functionally equivalent to F5 AppProtect rule sets.
- Built Tekton pipelines and Argo-CD GitOps workflows for OpenShift continuous delivery; used Bitbucket for version control and Artifactory for artefact management.
- Architected a localised Retrieval-Augmented Generation framework (n8n ingesting Loki logs and Bitbucket docs into a Qdrant vector database, served by Anthropic Claude) to automate technical support and root-cause analysis, integrated into existing Argo-CD/JIRA workflows.
- **Impact:** improved operational efficiency and reduced transformation costs for a Critical National Infrastructure programme.

DevOps Release Train Engineer — Goldman Sachs

ACLDigital / Alten / Cprime / Omantel · Oman, Muscat (onsite) · August 2023 – March 2024

- Assessed release practices against a DevSecOps Maturity Matrix and built a new CI/CD framework across OpenShift (Kubernetes), on-premises gateways, and Azure Sentinel.
- Delivered **Azure DevOps**-driven CI/CD across GCP, Azure, and AWS; integrated Cloud Build on GCP to streamline deployments.
- Used Logic Apps and Azure Virtual Desktop/VDI to serve a population of 4M+ users, including Azure subscription provisioning.
- **Impact:** improved release cadence and reduced manual deployment errors across a regulated financial services environment.

DevOps Consultant — Ypsomed Switzerland

Hybrid Contract · April 2022 – April 2023

- Planned and executed a Git/TFS/VSS migration to **Azure DevOps** for a regulated healthcare device manufacturer, producing full documentation to meet healthcare regulatory requirements.
- Worked across Git, TFS, VSS, VMware, and Citrix, using GitHub Copilot to accelerate legacy code refactoring during the migration.
- **Impact:** successful migration to Git and Azure DevOps with full regulatory compliance and zero legacy-system rollback.

DevOps Engineer — Cushman & Wakefield

Remote Contract · May 2022 – January 2023

- Implemented Infrastructure as Code for a data environment with no existing automated provisioning, using ARM templates and Bicep to deploy to **Azure**.

- Built and maintained **Azure DevOps** pipelines for practical, DSL-based deployments, incorporating AI-assisted IaC validation.
- **Impact:** automated infrastructure provisioning, removing manual setup time from the delivery process.

DevOps Engineer — Emerson

Remote Contract · February 2022 – May 2022

- Solved teams getting stuck at docker-compose by building on-premise Kubernetes (mini-kube) training material and live debugging sessions for multiple stakeholders.
- Used **Bash** and **Python** scripting alongside Git and **Azure DevOps** to support on-premise Kubernetes debugging workflows.
- **Impact:** empowered development teams to deploy and debug on Kubernetes independently, removing a delivery bottleneck.

Senior DevSecOps Engineer — Concentra Analytics

Onsite Contract · April 2019 – November 2019

- Worked with orchestrators (Puppet, Chef) and cloud-native services (CloudFormation, S3, EC2, Lambda, API Gateway, RDS/PostgreSQL, RedShift, KMS) to isolate previously unmaintainable pipeline components.
- Used **Python**, Ruby, and PowerShell for configuration management and container CI/CD pipelines (Docker, ECS/EKS/Kubernetes); administered Linux systems at the command line daily.
- Worked hands-on with networking, routing, IPSec tunnelling, firewalls, ingress/egress, IAM, and encryption for secure pipeline isolation.
- **Impact:** improved resource isolation and simplified pipeline management across a multi-cloud estate.

Senior DevOps Engineer — Red Box Recorders

Onsite Contract · October 2018 – December 2018

- Migrated a CQRS microservices platform onto a new on-premise and cloud Kubernetes environment (Vagrant, Docker Compose, VMware, **CentOS**).
- Architected and deployed **NGINX** as the production reverse proxy and load balancer in front of the platform (EventStore, Redis, Minio), alongside MetalLB and Traefik for ingress orchestration and Terraform/ARM templates for infrastructure provisioning — handling SSL termination, path-based routing, and traffic cutover during the migration.
- Hardened the CentOS hosts with **SELinux running in enforcing mode**, rather than the common shortcut of disabling it — defining custom policy contexts/booleans so containerised services ran under mandatory access control without breaking functionality, reducing the container-breakout attack surface on an on-prem estate with no cloud-provider isolation to fall back on.
- Drove the migration cutover with **Bash** scripts (service start/stop ordering, health-check polling, log capture) and set up ELK (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) for microservices logging.

- **Impact:** delivered a fully orchestrated CQRS architecture with improved container visibility and troubleshooting.

DevOps Architect / Site Reliability Engineer — Scottish Enterprise & Craneware

Onsite Contracts · August 2017 – June 2018

- Built continuous delivery pipelines in **Azure DevOps (VSTS)** with Docker, Helm, and Kubernetes for multi-environment delivery.
- Implemented real-time monitoring (Application Insights, Log Analytics, Kafka) and ChatOps-driven release visibility.
- **Impact:** established continuous delivery to multiple environments, cutting release friction for both organisations.

Cloud Solution Architect — Microsoft

Hybrid · February 2016 – February 2017

- Ran architectural design sessions and proof-of-concept implementations to overcome cloud-migration resistance across enterprise customers.
- Delivered on IaaS/PaaS/SaaS patterns using **Azure DevOps (VSTS)**, ARM, PowerShell, Service Fabric, and Terraform.
- **Impact:** measurable increase in enterprise cloud-resource consumption across engaged accounts.

Additional Contract Engagements

Earlier and shorter contract engagements, all delivered through Azure DevOps/VSTS-based CI/CD with Git-based version control:

- **Canada Life – GWLE** (DevSecOps Engineer, May–Jul 2021) — Azure API Management automation, shift-left security.
- **Theta Trading** (Azure DevSecOps Engineer, Apr–May 2021) — ARM/YAML pipelines for trading systems, Pipeline-as-Code.
- **Sword** (Azure DevSecOps Engineer, Dec 2020–Apr 2021) — ARM/YAML pipelines for environment consistency.
- **Pexabo LLC** (DevOps Integration, Apr 2020–Dec 2021) — GCP transcoding pipelines, multi-cloud backup to AWS Glacier.
- **Ardent Blue Technologies / Lockheed Martin (TransfrVR)** (DevOps Lead/Consultant, 2019–2020) — Perforce/Unity build automation, Oculus VR release pipelines across distributed teams.
- **MMT Digital** (Senior DevOps Engineer, Jun–Oct 2018) — Docker/Kubernetes migration, Azure, Bash scripting, Terraform.
- **Smart Space Software** (Senior DevOps Engineer, Dec 2018–Apr 2019) — Service Fabric migration, PowerShell/**Python** scripting for CI.

- **Accenture** (Manager, 2015–2016) — SDLC and continuous-delivery management for enterprise Java platforms.
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References and detailed project portfolios available on request.